

Word family: **place / places / placed / placing / placement / misplace / misplaced / replace / replacement / displace / displacement**

Base word: place

Verb forms: place, places, placed, placing

Related forms / useful extensions: placement, misplace, misplaced, replace, replacement, displace, displacement

Important expressions: take place, in place, out of place, place an order, place a bet, place emphasis on, place trust/confidence in

Part of speech: noun(名詞) / verb(動詞)

Your sentence:

> “The ad showed ordinary people in stressful **places**, such as a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy office.”

A full family sweep confirms that **place is an extremely rich polysemy word**.

Its broad underlying concept is:

> **a particular position, location, or assigned point within a physical or abstract arrangement**

From that central idea, English develops meanings involving:

- * physical locations;
- * positions;
- * seats/spaces;
- * homes;
- * roles in society;
- * rankings;
- * available positions or admissions;
- * appropriate positions;
- * putting something somewhere;
- * making orders/bets;
- * assigning importance/trust;
- * and several important related words.

Meaning in your passage

Here, **places** means:

physical environments or locations where people are present and having an experience.

繁體中文: **人身處其中的實際地點／環境**

Natural translation:

> “ordinary people in stressful places”

「身處**令人感到壓力的環境／地方**中的普通人」

The examples clarify the sense:

* a packed train

* a busy café

* a noisy office

So here:

****place = 人實際身處、活動或經歷事情的地點／環境****

1. ****place = physical location/environment (地點／環境) — 地方; 場所; 地點****

This is your original meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The ad showed ordinary people in stressful ****places****.”

「廣告展示了一些身處**令人感到壓力的地方／環境**中的普通人。」

Practice 2

> “This is a quiet ****place**** to work.”

「這是一個適合工作的安靜**地方**。」

Practice 3

> “We visited several interesting ****places**** during the trip.”

「旅行期間, 我們去了幾個有趣的**地方**。」

****place = 某人或某事物可以實際存在、活動或發生事情的地理位置／環境****

2. **place** = particular position occupied by something (位置) — 位置; 所在之處

Here, the emphasis is not the wider location but **the exact position of something**.

Practice 4

> “Put the chair back in its usual **place**.”

「把椅子放回它平常的**位置**。」

Practice 5

> “Everything has its own **place** in the kitchen.”

「廚房裡每樣東西都有自己的**固定位置**。」

place = 某件物件在人或空間安排中所佔的特定位置

This is closely related to #1, but more precise:

* **place** = wider location

* **place** = exact position

3. **place** = available space for a person/object (空位/空間) — 位子; 位置; 空位

Practice 6

> “Is there a **place** for me at the table?”

「桌邊還有我的**位置/座位**嗎？」

Practice 7

> “There wasn’t enough **place** for all the equipment.”

In modern English, **space** would usually sound more natural here:

> “There wasn’t enough **space** for all the equipment.”

「沒有足夠的**空間**放置所有設備。」

So **place** commonly means an **available position**, especially for a person:

> “Save me a place.”

「替我留個**位子**。」

****place = 某人可以坐、站、加入或佔用的一個可用位置****

4. ****place = someone's home (住所) — 家; 住處****

A very common conversational use.

Practice 8

> “Let's meet at my ****place****.”

「我們在****我家／我的住處****見面吧。」

Practice 9

> “Her ****place**** is only five minutes from the station.”

「她的****住處****離車站只有五分鐘。」

****someone's place = 某人居住的房子、公寓或住所****

This is informal and very common.

Compare:

> my home

> my house

> my place

****my place**** is often the most conversational.

5. ****place = role/position in society, group, or system (角色／地位) — 位置; 地位; 角色****

Now the idea becomes abstract.

Practice 10

> “Everyone should understand their ****place**** in the team.”

「每個人都應該明白自己在團隊中的****角色和位置****。」

Practice 11

> “The invention has an important ****place**** in modern history.”

「這項發明在現代歷史中佔有重要的****地位****。」

****place = 某人／某事物在群體、制度、歷史或社會結構中所佔的角色或地位****

6. ****place = rightful/appropriate role (應有位置) — 應有的位置; 合適角色****

Practice 12

> “Technology has an important ****place**** in education.”

「科技在教育中有其重要的****角色和適當位置****。」

Practice 13

> “There is a ****place**** for humour even in serious discussions.”

「即使在嚴肅討論中，幽默也有其****適當的位置／作用****。」

****a place for something = 某事物在特定情況中具有合理、適合或有價值的角色****

7. ****place = rank/position in a competition (比賽排名) — 名次; 排名****

Practice 14

> “She finished in first ****place****.”

「她獲得了****第一名****。」

Practice 15

> “The team moved up to second ****place****.”

「球隊上升至**第二名**。」

****place = 在比賽、排名或競爭中所取得的名次****

Common:

* first place = 第一名

* second place = 第二名

* third place = 第三名

8. ****place = admission/available position in a school/course/team (名額) — 名額; 席位; 入讀資格****

A very useful education/institutional meaning.

Practice 16

> “She was offered a ****place**** at university.”

「她獲得了大學的****入學名額／學位****。」

Practice 17

> “There are only twenty ****places**** on the course.”

「這個課程只有二十個****名額****。」

****place = 學校、課程、團隊、活動等可以讓一個人加入的有限名額／位置****

Especially common in British English:

> ****a university place****

= 大學學位／入學名額

9. ****place = position/job/role available to someone (職位／席位) — 位置; 席位****

Practice 18

> “He earned a ****place**** on the team.”

「他成功取得球隊中的一個**席位／位置**。」

Practice 19

> “She secured a **place** on the committee.”

「她成功取得委員會的一個**席位**。」

****place = 團體、組織或選拔中可供某人加入的一個位置／資格****

This is closely related to #8.

10. ****place = point in a sequence/text/process (順序／文章) — 位置; 部分****

Practice 20

> “I lost my **place** in the book.”

「我忘了自己剛才讀到書中的哪個**位置**。」

Practice 21

> “Mark your **place** before closing the document.”

「關閉文件前, 先標記你看到的**位置**。」

****place = 在文章、序列或流程中目前所處的具體位置****

11. ****decimal place (數學) — 小數位****

A useful technical compound.

Practice 22

> “Round the number to two decimal **places**.”

「把這個數字四捨五入至兩個**小數位**。」

Practice 23

> “Give your answer to three decimal **places**.”

「答案請寫至三個**小數位**。」

decimal place = 小數點右邊某一數字所處的位置

12. **place value** (數學) — 位值

Practice 24

> “The **place value** of the 5 in 500 is five hundred.”

「500 中數字 5 的**位值**是五百。」

Practice 25

> “Children learn about **place value** in primary school.”

「小學生會學習數字的**位值概念**。」

place value = 一個數字因其在整個數字中的位置不同而具有的數值

This is a family compound rather than another ordinary sense of bare **place**.

13. **place + object + location** (動詞) — 放置; 擺放

Now **place** becomes a verb.

Meaning: To put something somewhere, often carefully or deliberately.

Practice 26

> “She **placed** the headphones on the desk.”

「她把耳機**放在**桌上。」

Practice 27

> “Please **place** your bag under the seat.”

「請把你的袋子**放在座位下面**。」

****place something somewhere = 有意識地把某件物品放到指定位置****

Compared with ****put****, ****place**** is often:

- * slightly more formal;
- * more deliberate/careful.

14. ****place + person + position/location (安排某人到某處) — 安排; 安置****

Practice 28

> “The agency ****placed**** him in a temporary job.”

「那間機構替他**安排了一份臨時工作**。」

Practice 29

> “The children were ****placed**** with foster families.”

「那些孩子被**安置到寄養家庭**。」

****place someone = 安排某人進入特定位置、工作、機構或照顧環境****

15. ****place an order (購物／商業) — 下單; 訂購****

An extremely common fixed collocation.

Practice 30

> “I ****placed an order**** for the headphones online.”

「我在網上**下單訂購了那副耳機**。」

Practice 31

> “Customers can ****place orders**** through the app.”

「顧客可以透過應用程式**下單**。」

****place an order = 正式提出購買商品／服務的要求****

Here ****place**** does not mean physically put the order somewhere.

16. ****place a bet(賭博／預測) — 下注****

Practice 32

> “He ****placed a bet**** on the race.”

「他在那場比賽上****下注****。」

Practice 33

> “You can ****place your bet**** before the game starts.”

「你可以在比賽開始前****下注****。」

****place a bet = 正式作出一項投注****

This is a fixed collocation.

17. ****place emphasis/stress/importance on + topic(重點／重要性) — 著重; 把重點放在.....****

A very important academic/business construction.

Practice 34

> “The company ****places great emphasis on**** customer service.”

「公司非常****重視顧客服務****。」

Practice 35

> “The course ****places more importance on**** practical skills.”

「這個課程****更加重視實用技能****。」

****place emphasis/importance on = 把較多注意力、重要性或重點給予某個對象****

This is metaphorical placement:

> “put importance onto something”

18. ****place trust/confidence/faith in + person/system (信任／信心) — 信任; 把信心寄託於.....****

Practice 36

> “Customers ****place their trust in**** the brand.”

「顧客把自己的****信任寄託在這個品牌上／信任這個品牌****。」

Practice 37

> “She ****placed complete confidence in**** her team.”

「她對團隊****完全信任／充滿信心****。」

****place trust/confidence in = 把信任或信心給予某個人、制度或事物****

Slightly formal.

19. ****place responsibility/blame on + person/thing (責任／責備) — 把責任／過錯歸於.....****

Practice 38

> “The report ****placed responsibility on**** senior management.”

「報告把****責任歸於****高層管理人員。」

Practice 39

> “It would be unfair to ****place all the blame on**** one person.”

「把所有****責任都歸咎於****一個人是不公平的。」

****place responsibility/blame on = 認定某人／某事物應承擔責任或過錯****

20. **place a call (電話) — 打電話**

Especially common in American/formal English.

Practice 40

> “She **placed a call** to the office.”

「她**打了一通電話到辦公室**。」

Practice 41

> “The assistant **placed several calls** that morning.”

「那名助理當天早上**打了幾通電話**。」

place a call = 撥打一通電話

Slightly more formal than:

> make a call / call someone

21. **place someone/something = identify/recognize (認出／想起) — 認出; 想起是誰／哪裡見過**

This is a very useful less-obvious meaning.

Practice 42

> “I recognize her face, but I can’t **place** her.”

「我認得她的臉，但**想不起在哪裡見過她／認不出她究竟是誰**。」

Practice 43

> “I know that voice, but I can’t quite **place** it.”

「我認得那個聲音，但一時**想不起是誰的／在哪裡聽過**。」

place someone/something = 能把熟悉的感覺與正確身分、來源或記憶聯繫起來

This is a genuinely distinct and excellent MCQ sense.

22. **take place** = happen/occur(事件) — 發生;舉行

This is a fixed expression rather than a phrasal verb, and it is far too important to omit.

Practice 44

> “The meeting will **take place** tomorrow.”

「會議將於明天**舉行**。」

Practice 45

> “The accident **took place** near the station.”

「事故在車站附近**發生**。」

take place = 某項事件發生／某項活動按安排舉行

Important:

> **take place** does not mean physically “take a location.”

23. **in place** = in the correct/intended position — 在正確位置;就位

Practice 46

> “Make sure the headphones are firmly **in place**.”

「確保耳機已牢牢**固定在正確位置**。」

Practice 47

> “The cover clicked **in place**.”

「蓋子卡入了**正確位置**。」

in place — physical = 處於本來應該所在的正確位置

24. ****in place = established/ready/operating (制度／安排) — 已建立; 已準備妥當****

A figurative extension.

Practice 48

> “The company has new safety procedures ****in place****.”

「公司已經****建立並實施****新的安全程序。」

Practice 49

> “Everything is ****in place**** for the launch.”

「發布所需的一切都已經****準備妥當****。」

****in place — system/arrangement = 所需制度、措施或安排已經建立並可正式運作****

25. ****out of place = not in correct position — 放錯位置; 不在原位****

Practice 50

> “One of the buttons looks ****out of place****.”

「其中一個按鈕看起來****位置不對／放錯了位置****。」

Practice 51

> “Nothing was ****out of place**** in the room.”

「房間裡所有東西都放得整整齊齊, 沒有任何東西****不在原位****。」

****out of place — physical = 沒有處於本來應該所在的位置****

26. ****out of place = socially/contextually inappropriate — 格格不入; 不合時宜****

A very important figurative meaning.

Practice 52

> “I felt **out of place** at the formal dinner.”

「在那場正式晚宴上，我覺得自己**格格不入／很不自在**。」

Practice 53

> “That joke felt **out of place** during such a serious discussion.”

「在這麼嚴肅的討論中，那個笑話顯得**很不合時宜**。」

out of place — figurative = 與周圍的人、環境、情境或場合不協調、不適合

27. **know your place** = know your social/organizational position — 知道自己的身分／位置

This expression can be neutral or strongly patronizing depending on context.

Practice 54

> “Everyone needs to understand their **place** within the organization.”

「每個人都需要明白自己在機構中的**角色和位置**。」

Practice 55

> “He told her to ‘know her **place**,’ which sounded insulting.”

「他叫她『**認清自己的身分**』，聽起來很侮辱人。」

know your place = 知道自己在社會／組織中的位置；若直接用來命令人，常帶貶低或階級意味

28. **placement** = act of putting/positioning something — 放置；位置安排

Practice 56

> “The **placement** of the speakers affects the sound.”

「揚聲器的**擺放位置**會影響聲音效果。」

Practice 57

> “Careful button **placement** makes the device easier to use.”

「仔細安排按鈕的**位置**可以令裝置更容易使用。」

placement = 把某物安排在特定位置的方式／結果

29. **placement** = job/training position (工作／實習) — 實習; 工作安排; 職位安排

Practice 58

> “She completed a six-month work **placement**.”

「她完成了為期六個月的**工作實習／職場實習**。」

Practice 59

> “The university helps students find industry **placements**.”

「大學協助學生尋找業界**實習職位**。」

placement = 安排某人到公司、機構或工作環境進行實習／工作的一段職位安排

Especially common in British education.

30. **placement** = ranking/position obtained (排名／安置結果) — 名次; 分配位置

Practice 60

> “Her high **placement** in the competition surprised everyone.”

「她在比賽中取得的高**名次**令大家感到驚訝。」

Practice 61

> “Student **placement** depends on test performance.”

「學生被**分配到哪個程度／班級**取決於測試表現。」

****placement = 根據測試、選拔或安排而被分配到某個級別、位置或名次****

31. ****misplace = put something somewhere and temporarily lose it — 放錯地方；一時找不到****

A very useful family extension.

Practice 62

> “I’ve ****misplaced**** my keys.”

「我把鎖匙****放錯地方，一時找不到了****。」

Practice 63

> “She often ****misplaces**** her phone.”

「她經常把電話****隨手放錯地方而找不到****。」

****misplace = 把某物放到錯誤／忘記的位置，因此暫時找不到****

This is different from permanently ****lose****.

32. ****misplaced = directed toward the wrong person/thing (信任／信心／情感) — 錯放的；不恰當的****

A figurative extension.

Practice 64

> “His confidence was ****misplaced****.”

「他的信心****放錯了地方／信錯了對象****。」

Practice 65

> “She showed ****misplaced**** loyalty to the company.”

「她對公司的忠誠有點****給錯了對象／不值得****。」

****misplaced — figurative = 情感、信任或信心給予了不適合或不值得的對象****

33. ****replace** = put something/someone in the position of another — 取代; 替換******

A major related lexical extension.

Practice 66

> “We need to ****replace**** the old battery.”

「我們需要****更換****舊電池。」

Practice 67

> “Machines cannot completely ****replace**** human judgment.”

「機器不能完全****取代****人類判斷。」

****replace** = 讓新的／另一個人或事物佔據原本由某人／某物擔任的位置或功能******

34. ****replacement** = substitute/new item/person — 替代品; 替換物; 接替者******

Practice 68

> “The company sent a ****replacement**** product.”

「公司寄來了一件****替換產品****。」

Practice 69

> “They are looking for a ****replacement**** for the manager.”

「他們正在尋找一位經理的****接替人選****。」

****replacement** = 用來接替原有人／物位置、功能或角色的人／事物******

35. ****displace** = force someone/something out of its usual position — 使移位; 迫使離開******

Practice 70

> “The impact **displaced** several parts of the machine.”

「撞擊令機器的幾個零件**移位**。」

Practice 71

> “The conflict **displaced** thousands of families.”

「衝突迫使數以千計的家庭**離開家園／流離失所**。」

displace = 使某人／某物被迫離開原本的位置、住所或角色

36. **displacement** = movement/removal from original position — 移位; 流離失所

Practice 72

> “The earthquake caused major population **displacement**.”

「地震造成大量人口**流離失所**。」

Practice 73

> “Engineers measured the **displacement** of the structure.”

「工程師測量了結構的**位移**。」

displacement = 某人／某物離開原有位置的過程或程度; 可指人口遷離或物理位移

Important distinction: **place** vs **location**

place

broader and more natural in everyday language.

It can include:

- * location;
- * atmosphere;
- * role;
- * home;

* position.

location

more specifically means:

where something is geographically or physically situated.

> “This is a nice place.”

= 這是一個很好的地方。

> “What is the exact location?”

= 確切位置在哪裡？

You cannot usually replace every **place** with **location**.

Important distinction: **place vs position**

place

broader.

position

often emphasizes exact arrangement, orientation, rank, or role.

> “Put it back in its place.”

「放回原位。」

> “Adjust the position of the screen.”

「調整螢幕位置。」

Important distinction: **place vs space**

place

= a particular location/position.

space

= available room/area.

> “This is a good place for the chair.”

「這是放椅子的好位置。」

> “There isn’t enough space for the chair.”

「沒有足夠空間放椅子。」

This distinction is extremely useful.

Important distinction: **place vs area**

place

can refer to one particular location.

area

usually refers to a broader region or section.

> “This is a nice place to sit.”

「這是個很適合坐下的地方。」

> “This area is very quiet.”

「這一帶很安靜。」

Important distinction: **place vs home**

You already curated **home**.

home

emphasizes residence and belonging.

place

can conversationally mean the physical residence.

> “Come to my place.”

= 來我家。

But:

> “This city feels like home.”

means emotional belonging—not simply “my place.”

Important distinction: **put vs place**

put

very common, neutral.

> “Put the phone on the table.”

place

slightly more formal/deliberate and can imply careful positioning.

> “Place the phone on the charging pad.”

Both mean 「放」, but **place** often sounds more controlled or instructional.

Important distinction: **place an order vs order**

Both are correct:

> “I ordered the headphones.”

> “I placed an order for the headphones.”

The second is more noun-based/formal/business-like.

Important distinction: **place** vs **rank**

place

often means the actual numbered position:

> first place

rank

can refer more broadly to ordering/status in a hierarchy.

> “The university ranks highly.”

「大學排名很高。」

Important distinction: **place** vs **spot**

spot

is more informal and often means a small/specific place.

> “This is a good spot for lunch.”

「這是個吃午餐的好地方。」

place

is broader and works in many more abstract senses.

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the genuinely useful modern family includes:

* **place** — location = 地方／場所

* **place** — position = 位置

* **place** — available position/seat = 位子

* **someone's place** = 某人的住所
 * **place — social/historical role** = 地位／角色
 * **place — ranking** = 名次
 * **place — admission/position** = 名額／席位
 * **place — sequence/text** = 所在位置
 * **decimal place** = 小數位
 * **place value** = 位值
 * **place — verb** = 放置／安置
 * **place an order** = 下單
 * **place a bet** = 下注
 * **place emphasis/importance on** = 著重
 * **place trust/confidence in** = 信任／寄予信心
 * **place responsibility/blame on** = 把責任歸於
 * **place a call** = 打電話
 * **place someone/something** = 認出／想起來源
 * **take place** = 發生／舉行
 * **in place** = 就位；制度已建立
 * **out of place** = 不在原位；格格不入
 * **placement** = 擺放；實習安排；分配位置
 * **misplace** = 放錯地方而找不到
 * **misplaced** = 信任／情感給錯對象的
 * **replace** = 取代／替換
 * **replacement** = 替代品／接替者
 * **displace** = 使移位／迫使離開
 * **displacement** = 位移／流離失所

I would stop there rather than pull in more remote formations.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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place — physical location	某人／某事物可以實際存在、活動或發生事情的地點／環境
place — exact position	某件物品在人或空間安排中所佔的特定位置
place — available seat/position	可讓某人坐、站、加入或佔用的一個位置／空位
someone's place	某人居住的住所／家
place — role/status	某人／某事物在社會、制度、歷史或群體中的角色或地位
place — ranking	在比賽或競爭中取得的名次
place — admission/slot	課程、學校、團隊或組織中的有限名額／席位
place — text/sequence	在文章、序列或流程中目前所在的位置
decimal place	小數點右邊的數字位置／小數位
place value	數字因所在位置不同而具有的數值

place — verb	有意把某人／某物放到指定位置或安排到特定角色	
place an order	正式提出購買商品／服務的要求；下單	
place a bet	作出投注／下注	
place emphasis on	把較多重視和注意力給予某個對象	
place trust in	把信任／信心給予某人或某事物	
place blame on	把過錯或責任歸於某人／某事	
place someone/something — identify	把熟悉感與正確身分／來源聯繫起來；認出／想起	
take place	某事件發生或某活動按安排舉行	
in place — physical	處於本來應該所在的正確位置	
in place — system	制度、措施或安排已建立並可運作	
out of place — physical	沒有處於原本應在的位置	
out of place — figurative	與周圍環境／場合不協調、不合適或格格不入	
placement	放置方式；亦可指實習／職位安排或級別分配	
misplace	把某物放錯／忘記位置，因而暫時找不到	
misplaced — figurative	信任、信心或情感給予了不值得／不適合的對象	
replace	讓另一人／物接替原有人／物的位置、角色或功能	
replacement	用來接替原有人／物的替代品／接替者	
displace	使某人／某物被迫離開原有位置、住所或角色	
displacement	某人／某物離開原位置的過程／程度；可指位移或流離失所	

For your original sentence

> “The ad showed ordinary people in stressful ****places****, such as a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy office.”

The exact meaning is:

****places = 人實際身處並進行活動的物理環境／場所****

So:

> ****stressful places****

= ****「令人感到壓力的地方／環境」****

such as:

> ****a packed train, a busy café, and a noisy office.****

And yes—****place**** was one of the richest omissions from our first scan. It is exactly the kind of ordinary-looking word the new Discovery SOP is designed to catch.